BONUS 03 — ZERO TO COMMISSION

Offer Research Cheat Sheet

Evaluate an affiliate offer before you promote it

The rule: Score every offer on all five checkpoints before you create content for it. As a rule of thumb, an offer should pass at least 4 of 5 — and it must never fail the *Sales page & claims check*. A good score does not guarantee sales or income; it simply helps you avoid obvious problems.

Score tracker Offer name: _____

Checkpoint 1 ☐ Pass ☐ Maybe ☐ Fail 2 ☐ Pass ☐ Maybe ☐ Fail 3 ☐ Pass ☐ Maybe ☐ Fail
4 ☐ Pass ☐ Maybe ☐ Fail 5 ☐ Pass ☐ Maybe ☐ Fail

01 Performance data

Does the offer show evidence that it sells?

WHY IT MATTERS

Listings that show real sales and conversion data tell you more than a nice sales page. Treat any threshold below as a rule of thumb, not a promise of results.

HOW TO CHECK

- Look at the stats on the marketplace listing (for example commission, popularity and refund/cancellation indicators, where shown).
- If conversion data isn't shown, you can ask the vendor. A reasonable vendor will tell you what they can.
- Be cautious of any offer with no track record at all — it may be fine, but you'd be the test.

Pass: Data is shown and looks healthy to you
Maybe: Some data shown, mixed signals
Fail: No data and no way to get it

02 Commission per sale

Is the payout worth the effort for you?

WHY IT MATTERS

Low payouts mean you need many sales to make a meaningful amount. A common rule of thumb is to prefer offers that pay enough to justify the time you'll spend.

HOW TO CHECK

- Write down the commission per sale in your currency, after any fees shown.
- Ask: how many sales would I need for this to be worth my time? Is that realistic for the audience I have *today*?
- Check whether the commission is one-time or recurring, and read the terms.

Pass: Payout feels worthwhile for the effort
Maybe: Borderline
Fail: Very low payout for the effort

03 Refund & cancellation rate

Do buyers stay happy with the product?

WHY IT MATTERS

A high refund or cancellation rate usually means unhappy buyers — and refunded sales can reduce or reverse your commission.

HOW TO CHECK

- Check the refund/cancellation indicator on the listing, if it's shown.
- Read the product's refund policy and the return period.
- If you wouldn't be comfortable explaining a refund to your follower, that's a signal.

Pass: Low refund rate, clear policy
Maybe: Unclear or average
Fail: High refund rate or vague policy

04 Sales page & claims check

Would you be comfortable standing behind this page?

WHY IT MATTERS

You are putting your name next to this offer. Misleading pages create reputational and legal risk for you, not just the vendor.

HOW TO CHECK

- Load the page on your phone — most buyers will.
- Check for: a clear price, delivery method, refund terms, real contact/company details.
- Red flags: guaranteed income, fake-looking testimonials, countdown timers that reset, “secret” claims, unrealistic before/after results.
- Ask: would I buy this myself? Could I repeat its claims truthfully in my own content?

Pass: Clear, honest, professional page
Maybe: Okay but dated or vague
Fail: Misleading claims or looks untrustworthy

05 Buyer-intent match

Does this offer fit what your audience is actually looking for?

WHY IT MATTERS

Passive interest is not the same as active intent. Offers that solve a problem your audience is already searching to solve are easier to promote honestly.

HOW TO CHECK

- Search your platform for the problem the offer solves. Is anyone asking about it?
- Look at comments: are people asking “where can I get this?” or just scrolling past?
- Be able to say in one sentence who this is for — and who it is *not* for.

Pass: Clear audience need and demand
Maybe: Some interest
Fail: Little visible demand

Before you promote anything

- Read the vendor's affiliate terms, including what you are and aren't allowed to say.
- Disclose your affiliate relationship clearly every time.
- Only describe the product and results truthfully; never promise income.

Notes

Use this sheet alongside Module 02 of Zero to Commission.

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